

ACME GENERAL INSURANCE COMPANY LIMITED

Standard Operating Procedure - Health Claims Processing

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This Standard Operating Procedure governs the handling of cashless pre-authorisation requests and reimbursement claims by claims processing staff and the Third Party Administrator. It is an internal document and does not confer any rights on policyholders.

SECTION 1 - CASHLESS PRE-AUTHORISATION

1.1 Receipt and Acknowledgement

Every pre-authorisation request received from a Network Provider must be acknowledged within thirty minutes of receipt. The acknowledgement must carry a unique pre-authorisation reference number in the format PA-YYYY-NNNNNN.

1.2 Decision Timelines

A decision on a planned pre-authorisation request must be communicated within four hours of receipt of a complete request. For emergency admissions the decision must be communicated within one hour. Where a decision cannot be taken within these timelines, an interim response stating the reason and the expected decision time must be issued.

1.3 Query Management

Where information is insufficient, a single consolidated query must be raised. Serial queries on the same request are not permitted. If the response to a query is not received within forty-eight hours, the request may be closed as incomplete, and the Insured Person must be informed that a reimbursement claim may still be filed.

1.4 Enhancement Requests

Requests to enhance an approved pre-authorisation amount must be decided within two hours. Enhancement is permitted only up to the balance Sum Insured after taking into account applicable sub-limits and co-payment.

SECTION 2 - REJECTION REASON CODES

Every rejection or partial approval must carry one of the following codes together with the specific Policy clause relied upon. Free-text rejection reasons are not permitted, and a rejection recorded without a clause reference must be returned to the assessor.

Code	Description	Policy clause
PED_WAITING_PERIOD	Condition is pre-existing and the waiting period is not complete	Clause 5.1
SPECIFIED_DISEASE_WAIT	Specified disease within the 24 month waiting period	Clause 5.2
INITIAL_WAITING_PERIOD	Claim within the first 30 days and not accidental	Section 5
EXCL_DENTAL	Dental treatment not necessitated by an accident	Clause 4.11
EXCL_COSMETIC	Cosmetic or aesthetic treatment	Clause 4.12
EXCL_OBESITY	Obesity surgery, BMI criteria not met	Clause 4.13
EXCL_INFERTILITY	Infertility or assisted reproduction	Clause 4.14
EXCL_HAZARDOUS	Injury from professional hazardous sport	Clause 4.15
ROOM_RENT_LIMIT	Room rent exceeds eligibility, proportionate deduction applied	Section 3
SUBLIMIT_EXHAUSTED	Benefit sub-limit already utilised for the Policy Year	Section 3
NON_DISCLOSURE	Material fact not disclosed in the proposal	Clause 7.5
DOC_INSUFFICIENT	Required documents not received within the stipulated period	Clause 6.3

SECTION 3 - REIMBURSEMENT CLAIMS

3.1 Document Checklist

A reimbursement claim is complete only when the claim form duly signed, the original discharge summary, itemised hospital bill, payment receipts, investigation reports, prescriptions, and the identity proof of the Insured Person have all been received. Any deficiency must be communicated in a single consolidated letter within seven days of receipt.

3.2 Assessment

The assessor must verify the admissibility of the claim against the Policy Wording in force on the date of admission, and not the wording current at the time of assessment. Where the Policy has been renewed with a change in terms, the wording applicable to the date of loss governs.

3.3 Settlement

An admissible claim must be settled within thirty days of receipt of the last necessary document. Where settlement is delayed beyond this period for reasons attributable to the Company, interest at the bank rate plus two per cent is payable for the period of delay.

SECTION 4 - ESCALATION MATRIX

Level	Owner	Trigger	Response time
L1	Claims Associate	Standard claim within limits	30 days
L2	Claims Manager	Claim value above Rs. 5,00,000	15 days
L3	Medical Review Board	Disputed medical necessity	7 days
L4	Grievance Officer	Policyholder complaint	15 days
L5	Insurance Ombudsman	Unresolved after L4	As per statute

SECTION 5 - QUALITY CONTROL

5.1 Sampling

A minimum of five per cent of all settled claims and one hundred per cent of all repudiated claims must be reviewed by the quality team each month.

5.2 Repudiation Review

No claim may be repudiated without a second-level review. The reviewer must confirm that the rejection code, the clause reference and the communication to the Insured Person are consistent with one another.